predominant position and its pursuit should encourage candid and uninhibited communication.

The leader must be able to make sound judgements. This ability, of course, is the product of technical and tactical proficiency. It is this ability that enables the team to keep its goals in sight and work smoothly towards achieving it.

An unfailing sense of justice is imperative. This quality ensures caution in dealing with all kinds of cases and provides a correct perspective of the entire scenario. Also, it underpins one's ability to command with impartiality and consistency.

Finally, the essence of leadership appears to be in the display of a supreme degree of unselfishness. A leader never ever takes advantage of situations for personal pleasure, gain or safety at the cost of his or her subordinates or the institution in which he or she serves. A totally uncompromising commitment to one's profession takes precedence over all other factors.

By and large, public attention is focused on a crime *after* it has been committed and on the criminal only as long as the trial takes place. (In India, because of the inordinate delay in prosecution and the extremely long periods of incarceration in prison pending trial, the role of the authorities is more often than not limited to arrest and imprisonment.) It is in this context that the 'criminal' has been isolated from society and therefore he or she does not pose any further threat to it. But that is not as it should be. It is here that fresh-thinking, innovative leadership should make its presence felt. Imprisonment should be viewed as only a deterrent and a periodic sanction and the offender must ultimately return to the same society of which he or she is a part. It, therefore, becomes imperative that during the time spent in prison the leadership must ensure that the offender is suitably corrected so that his or her reinduction into society proves successful. Imprisonment, therefore, cannot be treated as meaning a mere locking up of the 'criminal' and throwing the key away. This awareness has pervaded prison managements worldwide and has compelled them into desiring to become progressive, receptive to change and to work under public scrutiny.